

119.2 HEDGING

Hedging words and phrases can be added to a sentence to make its meaning less definite, direct, or strong.



Polls **{ suggest
indicate }** that locals dislike the new statue.

Hedging verbs.

It is **{ arguably
potentially }** the strangest statue around.

Hedging adverbs.

**{ To a certain degree,
To some extent, }** locals feel their views are being ignored.

Hedging phrases.

119.3 "SEEM" AND "APPEAR"

"Seem" and "appear" are words used to distance oneself from a statement. This is useful when it is not certain if the statement is true.



The prisoners **{ seem
appear }** to have vanished.

"Seem" and "appear" are often followed by another verb in the infinitive.

It **{ seems
appears }** that the prison cell was left unguarded.

"It seems" or "It appears" can be followed by a "that" clause.

It would **{ seem
appear }** that a file was used to break the bars.

"Would" adds even more distance or uncertainty.